

M|A
MALCOLM AINSCOUGH
COLLECTION

RECOMMENDED PACKING LIST

Duffel Bag – Recommended type:

It is crucial that your primary bag be 'soft sided' to allow easy storage on light aircraft.

If you prefer a rolling duffel, please make sure it is only solid on one end (rollers, on one end, are permitted). Many have solid frames on the "bottom" which makes it extremely difficult to fit into the small baggage compartments on the light aircraft.

Please take careful note of the luggage weight limits indicated on your travel itinerary, usually 40lb per person. This restriction does not include 'hand-luggage' and we encourage you to bring a backpack/camera bag or similar in addition to your primary luggage.

Please find herewith a list of suggested items which should be used as a guideline whilst planning your trip:

As a general rule, comfortable, casual 'wash and wear' clothes are recommended. Muted colors are recommended for game-viewing. Game-drives are conducted in the early morning and late afternoon which can be very cold, especially in winter (May – August).

Clothing:

The most practical items to pack for safari is predominantly casual clothing:

- Khaki, green, beige, brown and neutral colors (dark blue and black should be avoided [on game drives], as it attracts Tsetse flies). White/black may be worn in camps and lodges.
- Shirts with long sleeves (even in summer, as protection from the sun, mosquitoes and Tse tse flies)
- T-shirts
- Shorts or a light skirt
- Jeans or safari trousers for evenings and cooler days
- A jacket and sweater are recommended for early morning and evening game drives
- Lightweight water-proof jacket
- Swim and beachwear
- Comfortable walking shoes
- Sun block, sunglasses, hat, moisturizer and lip-salve are all essentials
- Strong insect repellent like Mozzie Guard (www.mosi-guard.com)
- Binoculars and camera equipment
- Good quality safari clothing is available in Safari Shops

Notes:

Most safari camps / lodges and hotels provide basic toilet amenities.

More formal attire is usually required only when staying in the more prestigious city hotel establishments or on any of the luxury trains.

DESCRIPTION IN MORE DETAIL:

We recommend that you limit your luggage to the basics:

1. Sun hat/bush hat.
2. Headscarf/bandana – particularly for dusty dry regions.
3. Golf-shirts and/or T-shirts – preferably with a sleeve to protect your shoulders from the sun.
4. Long-sleeved cotton shirts.
5. Shorts and/or skirts – short skirts are not practical for getting in and out of game drive vehicles.
6. Long trousers/slacks.
7. Track suit.
8. Pajamas – lightweight for summer and warm/thermal for winter.
9. Underwear – on game drives the roads can be bumpy and uneven so a suitable bra may be required.
10. Socks – thermal options are recommended for the winter months.
11. Good closed walking shoes (running/tennis shoes are fine).
12. Sandals – preferably low heeled or flat if you are going on safari.
13. Swimming costume.
14. Lightweight jersey or fleece in summer.
15. Light rain gear or jacket for summer months.
16. Warm jersey or fleece plus anorak or parka in winter.
17. Additionally, a scarf, gloves, and beanies/woolen hats for the cold winter months.
18. More formal attire for your stay at prestigious city hotels or on one of the luxury trains.

Equipment/Other:

1. Good quality sunglasses, UV protected, preferably polarized. Tinted fashion glasses are not optimal in strong light.
2. If you wear contact lenses, we recommend that you bring along a pair of glasses in case you experience irritation from dust.
3. Flashlight.
4. Southern African bird guide if you are a keen birder, e.g., Newman's or Sasol.
5. Personal toiletries (basic amenities supplied by most establishments).
6. Malaria tablets (if applicable).
7. Antihistamine tablets if you suffer from any allergies.
8. Anti-nausea tablets if you suffer from motion sickness.
9. Moisturizing cream and suntan lotion – SPF 30 or higher recommended.
10. Insect repellent for body application e.g. Tabard, Rid, Jungle Juice, etc.
11. Basic medical kit (aspirins, plasters, Imodium, antiseptic cream and antihistamine cream etc.)
12. Tissues/Wet Wipes.
13. Visas, tickets, passports, money, credit cards, insurance details etc.
14. Camera equipment including spare batteries, chargers, flash cards, memory sticks and cleaning materials.
15. Waterproof/dustproof bag or cover for your camera.
16. BINOCULARS – we highly recommended that you bring your own pair for viewing both wildlife and birds. 8x40 and 10x42 are the recommended general-purpose binocular specifications.

NOTE 1:

Bright colors and white are not advisable whilst on safari.

Camouflage clothing is not recommended for travel in African countries (camouflage or military-inspired clothing is prohibited when travelling in Zimbabwe).

NOTE 2:

Laundry: Most lodges, camps and hotels do their best to deliver a same day laundry service, weather permitting. Dry cleaning can be arranged at most hotels but is not available at lodges and camps.

At the lodges soap suds are generally provided in your room for delicate items. Please be mindful that, due to culture and customs in many of the areas in which we operate, some lodges/camps do not wash underwear. At some camps/lodges, a mesh laundry bag is supplied so that guests may place their underwear in this bag which will be machine washed and returned in the mesh bag.

While most lodges/camps can arrange for your shoes to be polished, we regret that we are unable to provide a service for these to be washed.

NOTE 3:

Most lodges and camps carry reference materials in the main areas, guest rooms and vehicles, so it is not necessary to bring these with you. However, we highly recommend that you do bring your own pair of binoculars to get the most out of your safari.

NOTE 4:

Where applicable, a printed copy of your travel, medical and evacuation insurance that includes the policy reference number, name of insurer, name/s of person/s covered and the contact telephone number/s in the advent of a medical emergency.

NOTE 5:

Most hotels/lodges provide international adaptors but, to err on the side of caution, we suggest that you bring your own.

FIRST AID:

Although most hotels and lodges are equipped with a first aid kit, we suggest that you bring a small airtight container with a few well-chosen articles, such as plasters, travel sickness tablets, antiseptic cream, antihistamine cream, pain relieving tablets for headaches, indigestion tablets, sunscreen, eye drops, insect repellent, medication for upset stomachs and after-sun moisturizer. We remind travelers who have any allergies, e.g. insect stings, or an asthma condition, to pack the required medication.